WEBSITE SPEED CHECK · NOVEMBER 11, 2026

mosaicist.com: *why the site loads slowly*

In short. The site looks beautiful, but it is heavy. Opening the home page makes a phone or computer download about **57 megabytes**. A well-built page weighs 2–3 MB, so the home page is roughly 20 times heavier than it should be.

Almost all of that weight (95%) comes from two background videos. They are uploaded in 4K, the quality meant for a large TV, and phones receive them in the same quality. The server, the hosting and the design itself are fine. All of this can be fixed without changing how the site looks.

WHY IT MATTERS

What this means for the business

Visitors leave

On a phone, the first text appears only after 4.7 seconds, and the screen is dark until then. According to Google, more than half of mobile visitors leave if a page takes longer than 3 seconds to load.

Google ranks it lower

Loading speed (Core Web Vitals) is one of Google's ranking factors. A slow site appears below its competitors in search results.

Mobile data usage

One visit to the home page uses about 57 MB of mobile data. On a typical 4G connection (10 Mbit/s) that takes about 45 seconds to download.

GOOGLE'S SCORE

Google Lighthouse score

Lighthouse is Google's official tool for measuring site speed. It scores pages from 0 to 100: **90 and above** is good, 50–89 needs improvement, below 50 is poor.

ON A PHONE

58 / 100

needs improvement, close to poor

ON A COMPUTER

78 / 100

needs improvement

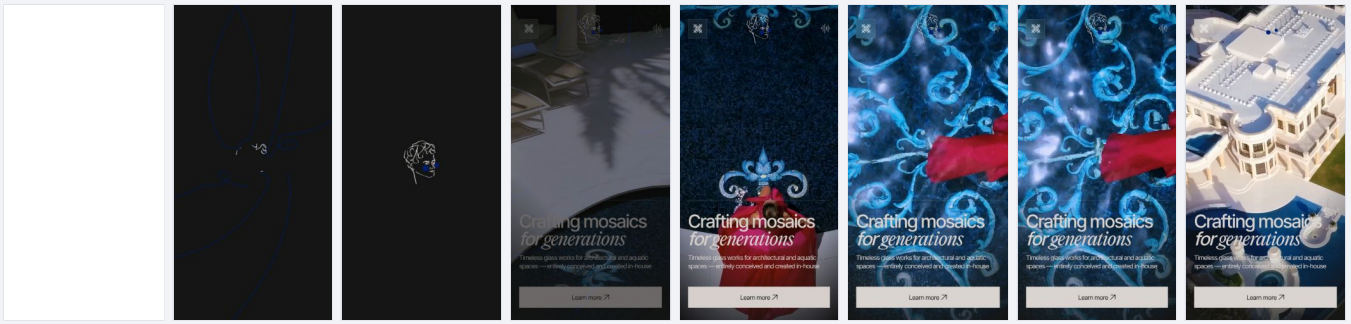
WHAT WE MEASURE	PHONE	COMPUTER	GOOD IF
When the first text or image appears on screen	4.7 s	1.4 s	under 1.8 s
When the main block of the first screen is visible	4.7 s	2.2 s	under 2.5 s
When the page is fully ready to respond to taps and clicks	7.6 s	2.2 s	under 3.8 s
Does the layout jump while loading	no	no	no
Page weight	57 MB	62 MB	under 2–3 MB
Server response time	0.04 s	0.04 s	under 0.6 s

The phone test simulates a mid-range smartphone on a mobile connection. This is how Google evaluates every site.

SCREENSHOTS

What a visitor sees while the page loads

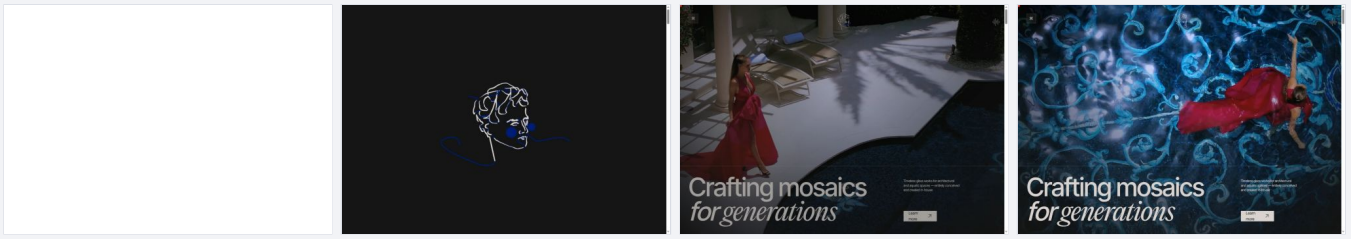
Phone, second by second



0.8 s · 1.6 s · 2.4 s · 3.3 s · 4.1 s · 4.9 s · 5.7 s · 6.5 s

For the first 2.5 seconds the screen is dark or blank. The headline “Crafting mosaics for generations” becomes readable at about 3 seconds, and the full image appears by 6 seconds.

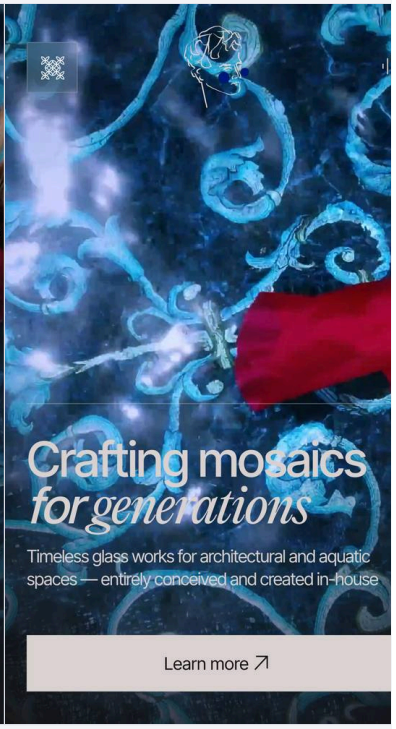
Computer



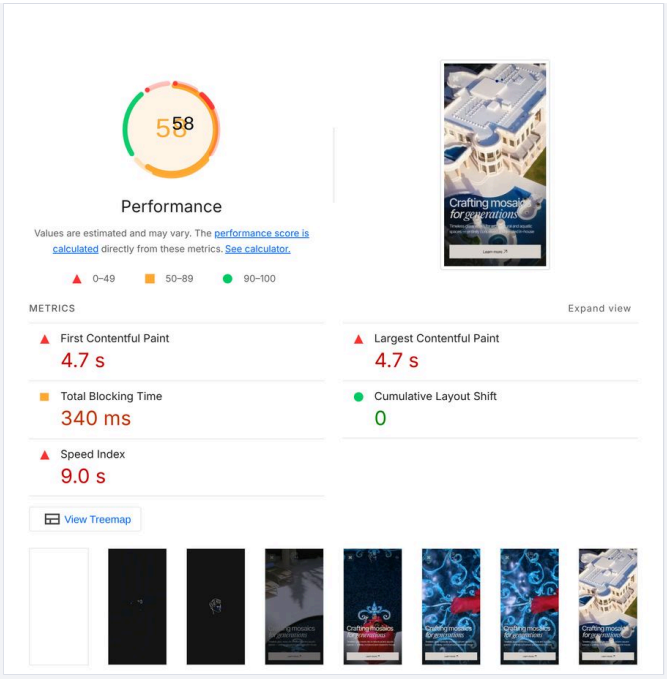
0.7 s · 2.1 s · 3.5 s · 4.9 s



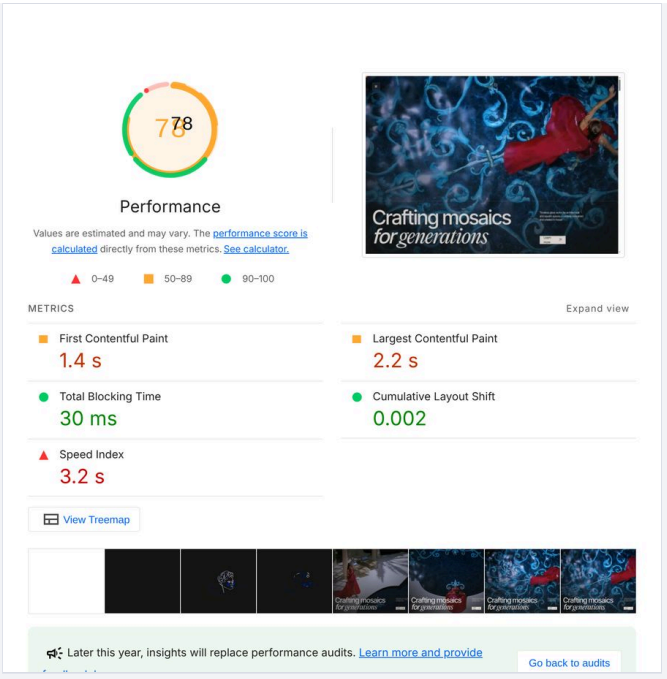
First screen on a computer after loading



The same screen on an iPhone 13. The video arrives here in 4K



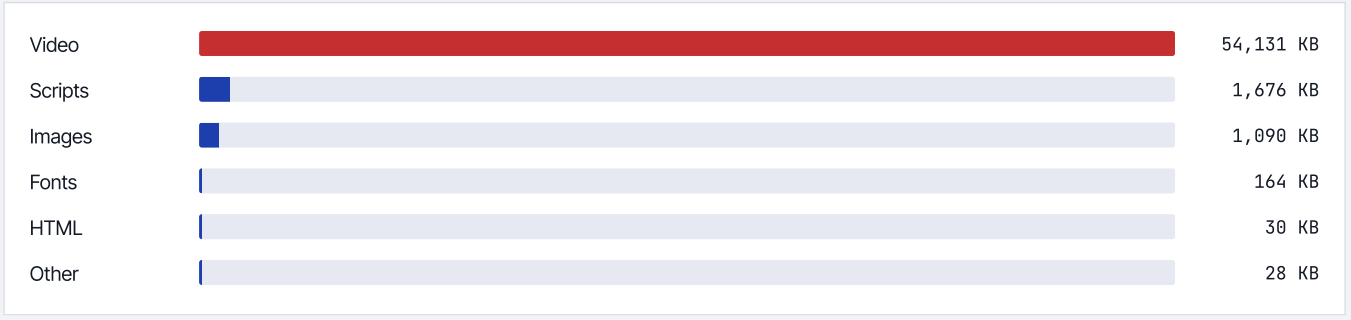
Original Google Lighthouse report, phone



Original Google Lighthouse report, computer

WHERE THE 57 MB GO

What the home page weight is made of



The red bar is video. Everything else (photos, text, fonts, animations) adds up to about 3 MB, which is normal.

VIDEO	WHERE ON THE PAGE	FILE SIZE	THE PROBLEM
Main video	First screen	52 MB	4K quality, 60 seconds long, includes an audio track even though it plays muted
Villa video (513 Middle River Drive)	Further down the page	142 MB	A source file made for a real estate listing, not prepared for the web. It starts downloading as soon as the page opens, even if the visitor never scrolls to it
Small animations (face, letter)	Various blocks	60–75 KB	All fine

Measured in a regular browser without scrolling: in the first 15 seconds the page downloaded about 70 MB on a computer and 67 MB on an iPhone.

OTHER PAGES

The rest of the site

The inner pages have a normal weight (2–4 MB), but they still open slower than they could: on a phone, the first text appears after 3–5 seconds. The cause is a set of technical settings shared by the whole site (see item 4 of the plan).

PAGE	SCORE (PHONE)	FIRST TEXT	WEIGHT
Home	58	4.7 s	57 MB
About	60	3.4 s	2.2 MB
Ray Corral (artist page)	69	4.1 s	4.3 MB
Awards	72	4.6 s	2.0 MB
Interior Spaces (projects)	79	3.2 s	1.8 MB
Press	81	3.7 s	2.0 MB

WHAT TO DO

Action plan

Items are listed by importance. The first three give the main effect, and none of them change how the site looks.

57 → ~3 MB
home page weight after items 1–2

≈ 2.5 s
possible gain on phones from item 4

90+
realistic target for the computer score after all items

1 · Urgent — Prepare the main video for the web

The video is currently uploaded in 4K, the quality meant for a large TV. A website background only needs Full HD on computers and lower quality on phones. The difference is barely visible, while the file becomes 10–20 times lighter. The clip can also be shortened to a 15–25 second loop, and the audio track removed, since the video plays muted anyway.

Effect: **–50 MB** Who: video editor or developer Look: unchanged

▼ Technical details for the developer

- Current: 3840×2160, H.264, 6.9 Mbit/s, 60 s, 52 MB, has an AAC track, `moov` atom at the end of the file (no faststart).
- Target: 1080p for desktop (2–4 MB), 720p or a vertical version for mobile (1–2 MB), no audio, with `+faststart`.
- Best option: Bunny Stream (HLS, adaptive quality). hls.js is already loaded on the site but unused, because the source is an MP4 from Bunny Storage.

```
ffmpeg -i hero.mp4 -t 20 -an -vf "scale=1920:-2,fps=25" -c:v libx264 -preset slow -crf 26 \
  -profile:v high -pix_fmt yuv420p -movflags +faststart hero-1080.mp4
ffmpeg -i hero.mp4 -t 20 -an -vf "scale=-2:720,fps=25" -c:v libx264 -preset slow -crf 28 \
  -pix_fmt yuv420p -movflags +faststart hero-720.mp4
```

2 · Urgent — Load the villa video only when the visitor scrolls to it

This video weighs 142 MB, three times more than the main one, and starts downloading as soon as the site opens. It should load only when the visitor scrolls to its section. The file itself should be compressed the same way as the main video.

Effect: **up to –140 MB** of data per visitor Who: developer Look: unchanged

▼ Technical details for the developer

- File `513_Middle_River_Drive…_RE_FULL_MLS.mp4`: 3840×2160, 23 Mbit/s, 49 s, no faststart.
- The `.bunny-bg` wrapper has `data-player-lazy="false"`. Set it to `"true"`, verify that the video attaches via IntersectionObserver, add `preload="none"`.
- Re-encode to 1080p without audio, 10–20 s, target up to 3–5 MB.

`3 · Urgent` **Show the cover image right away**

While the video loads, a still cover image should be shown in its place. The image already exists on the site, but a "load later" setting delays it, so for the first seconds visitors see a dark screen.

Effect: first screen appears **2–3 seconds sooner** Who: developer

▼ Technical details for the developer

- The `.bunny-bg__placeholder` image (WebP, 100 KB) has `loading="lazy"`. In Webflow set Load: Eager and add the attribute `fetchpriority="high"`.

`4 · Important` **Change the loading order of supporting files**

Before showing the page, the browser first downloads several libraries for animations, the player and fonts. Until they arrive, the screen stays blank. These files can be loaded in parallel, after the page is already shown. The animations will stay exactly the same.

Effect: by Google's estimate **up to −2.5 s** on phones, on every page Who: developer

▼ Technical details for the developer

- Render-blocking: hls.js (129 KB, 92% unused), SoundCloud `api.js`, GSAP, ScrollTrigger, `webfont.js`, jQuery.
- Move GSAP / Lenis / SplitText / Draggable from Head code to Footer code (or add `defer`), run inline code after `DOMContentLoaded`.
- Remove hls.js while the videos are MP4.
- Load Inter Tight via Site settings → Fonts instead of WebFont.js. Convert PP Editorial New from OTF to WOFF2 with `font-display: swap`.

`5 · Important` **Load the music player on click**

The SoundCloud playlist player loads for every visitor right away, even for those who never turn on the music. That is 1.4 MB and 36 separate requests. Because of the player, the browser's Back button also reloads the page instead of returning to it instantly. It is enough to load the player when the visitor taps the playlist icon.

Effect: **−1.4 MB**, instant Back button Who: developer Look: unchanged

▼ Technical details for the developer

- Iframe `w.soundcloud.com/player`: 1.2 MB of JS, 21 cover images, a third-party cookie. The unload handler inside the iframe disables back/forward cache. Fix: a facade that creates the iframe on click.

6 · Recommended

Tidy up the photos

Some portfolio photos are uploaded as screen captures in a heavy format (JPG) with names like “Screenshot 2026-10-28”. They should be converted to the modern WebP or AVIF format and given descriptive file names, which Google uses in image search. Most images also have no text description (alt text), which Google and screen readers for blind visitors rely on.

Effect: **–1 MB** on computers, better visibility in Google Images Who: content manager or developer

▼ Technical details for the developer

- LCP images on /about, /artists/ray-corral and /projects-categories/... have `loading="lazy"`; they need Eager.
- Inaccurate `sizes="100vw"` on cards: about 970 KB wasted on desktop.
- SVG icons have no `width` / `height`. The SVG logo is 54 KB; run it through SVGO.
- Duplicate markup for mobile (timeline, sticky slides): 1,005 DOM elements.
- Animations: ScrollTrigger takes 1.3 s of CPU time on phones. Initialize lazily, disable Lenis on touch devices.

7 · For search engines

Small technical settings for Google

These are not about speed, but they came up along the way:

- **The site is available at two addresses**, with and without www. Google may treat them as two copies of the same site. One address should be chosen as the main one, with the other redirecting to it.
- **There is no sitemap**, the list of pages for Google. In Webflow it is turned on with one checkbox.
- **37 main headings on one page.** There should be one main heading; the rest should be subheadings. Nothing will change visually.

Who: developer

▼ Technical details for the developer

- www and apex both return 200 with no 301, and there is no `rel="canonical"`. Publishing → Default domain.
- `/sitemap.xml` returns 404, `robots.txt` is empty. SEO → Auto-generate sitemap.
- 37 `<h1>` tags: change the tag to h2/h3, keep the classes.
- Icon links (logo, social) lack `aria-label`; low contrast on `.timeline_date-text`.

WHAT WORKS WELL

What not to touch

- **Hosting and server.** The site responds in 0.04 seconds, an excellent result.
- **Layout stability.** Nothing jumps during loading, and buttons don't shift under the finger.
- **Security.** The site works only over secure HTTPS.
- **Gallery.** Gallery photos are already in a modern lightweight format.

NEXT STEPS

How to proceed

1. Re-encode the two videos (items 1–2). This gives the main result.
2. Apply the settings in Webflow (items 3–5 and 7).

3. Repeat the measurements and compare them with this report.

4. After 4 weeks, check real-visitor data in Google Search Console (the Core Web Vitals section).

▼ **How the check was done**

November 11, 2026, Google Lighthouse 12 (Google's official tool), one run per page: the phone test emulates a mid-range smartphone on a mobile connection, the computer test uses the standard desktop mode. Video parameters were read from the source files; the weight in a regular browser was measured on a 1440×900 computer screen and an emulated iPhone 13. Results vary by 5–10 points between runs, which is normal. Google's real-visitor data was not available on the day of the check; it is worth reviewing in Google Search Console.